The Bell Beneath Blackwater — DM Audit

At low tide, a bell rings from a chapel swallowed by the sea. A fishing crew returns with no memory of seven missing days. The harbor guild wants the matter quiet before the Lantern Festival.

PLAYER EDITION
all secrets removed — safe to share

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Characters

Tessa Brine

Character · fighter · pc

Role: PC
Species: Dwarf
Status: Alive

Character sheet: included in the character sheets section at the end.

NPCs

Brother Orin

NPC · blackwater · session-1 · religion

Role: Shrine keeper; witness

Keeper of the shrine to The Drowned Lantern in Blackwater. Offers tea before answering questions. He remembers the chapel bell ringing once before, on the night his sister vanished.

Mara Vell

NPC · blackwater · session-1 · guild

Role: Harbormaster; patron
Species: Human
Disposition: Wary, wants discreet help
Found at: Blackwater harbor office

Harbormaster of Blackwater and public face of the Tidemarket Guild. She hires the party to locate the missing crew before the Lantern Festival.

Appearance

A weather-beaten woman in a blue oilskin coat, with a silver whistle and salt-stiff hair.

Personality

Clipped sentences; taps her whistle when worried. Practical, protective of the dockworkers, impatient with noble patrons.

- honors: The Drowned Lantern

Nella Reed

NPC · blackwater · session-1 · docks

A cheerful smuggler who pilots a skiff through the flooded alleys of Blackwater. Owes Mara Vell a favor. Her latest cargo was the Saltglass Key.

Locations

Blackwater

Location · blackwater · session-1

Kind: Capital settlement
Region: The Bell Coast
Population: ~18,000

A salt-stained harbor on The Bell Coast, where canal bridges link crowded markets and fishing quays. Mara Vell runs the harbor office, Brother Orin keeps the shrine, and Nella Reed knows the hidden waterways.

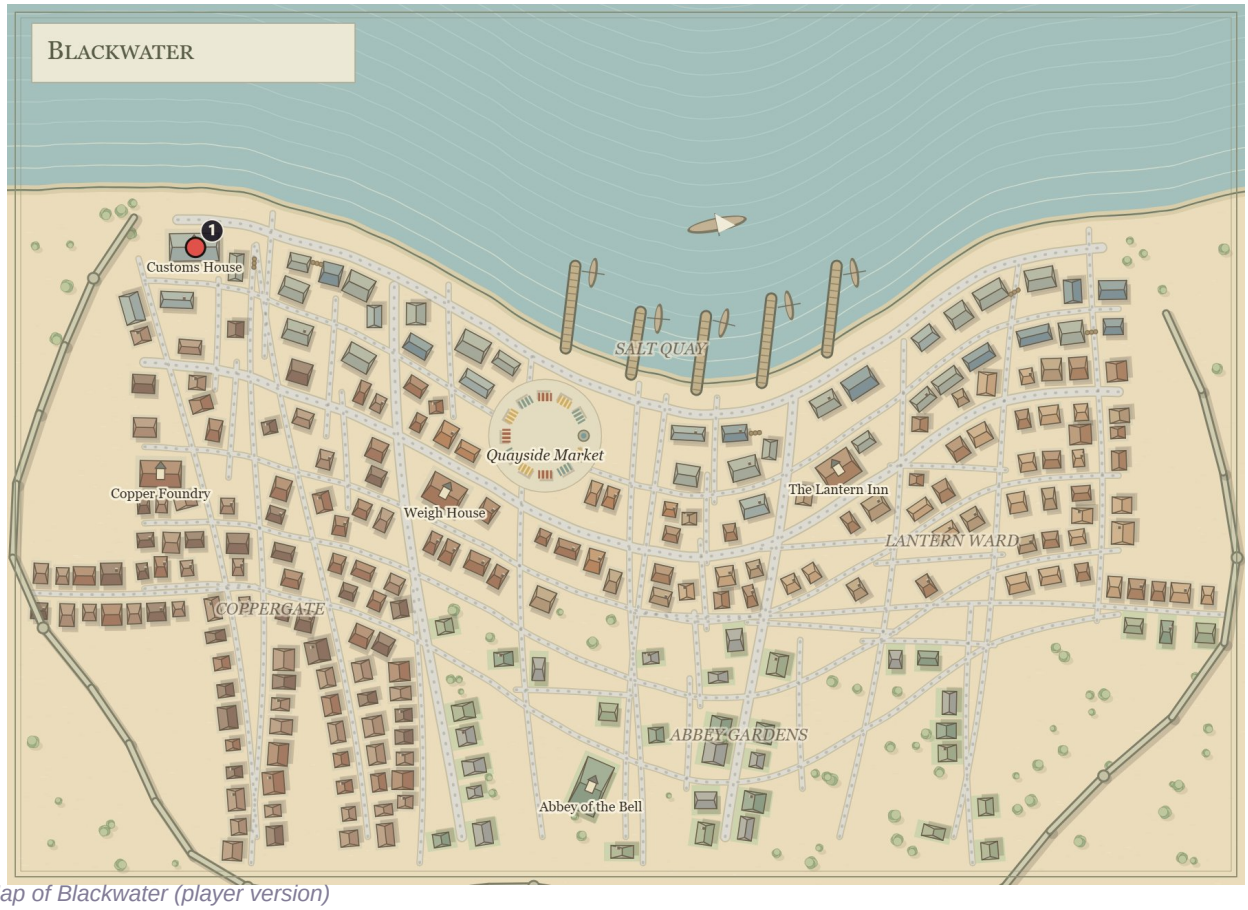
What you see

Blue nets drying on railings, brass lanterns above every doorway, gulls wheeling over the customs house. At low tide, a bell sounds from beyond the harbor mouth.

Who you meet

Mara Vell, Brother Orin, and Nella Reed. The Tidemarket Guild controls the warehouses.

- part of: The Bell Coast



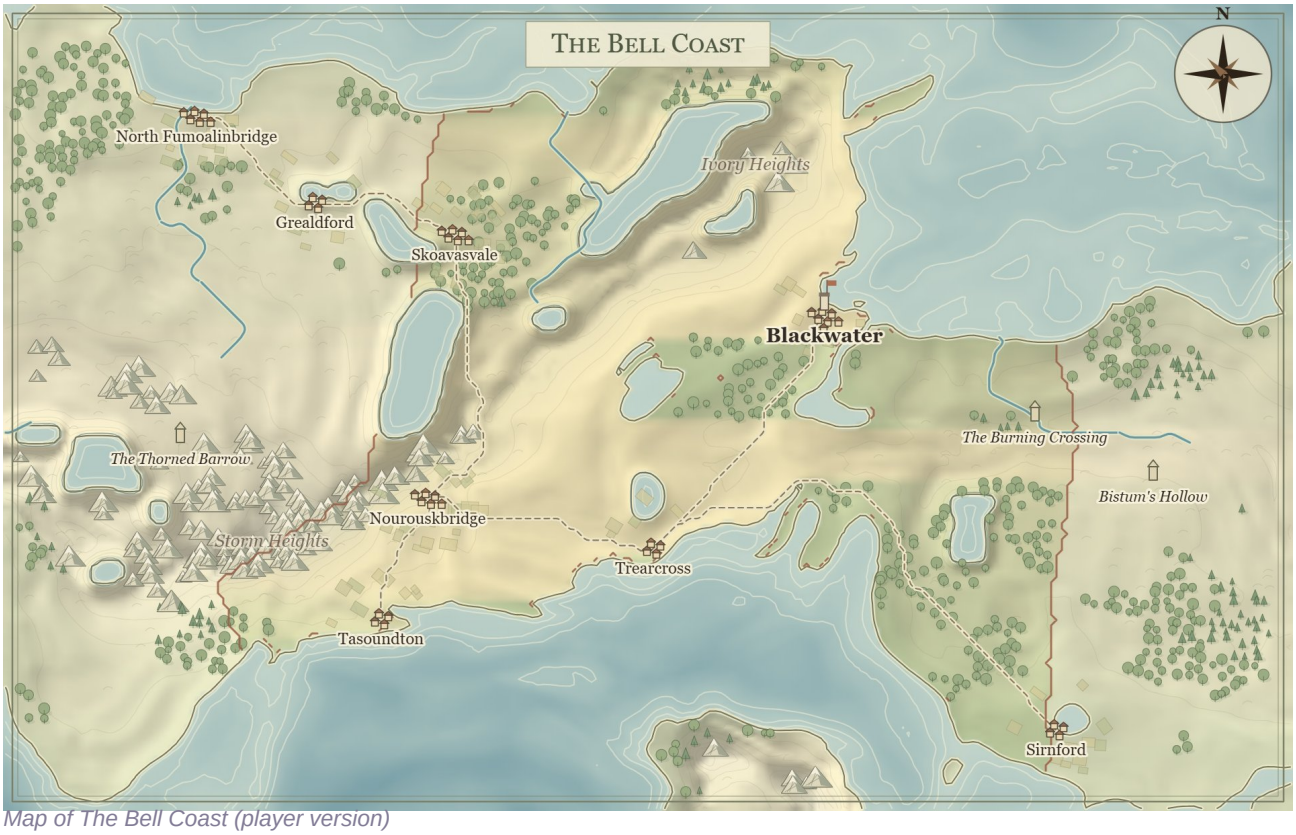
Map of Blackwater (player version)

1. Harbor office — Mara Vell — Mara Vell

The Bell Coast

Location

Kind: Region



Map of The Bell Coast (player version)

The Lantern Sea

Location



Map of The Lantern Sea (player version)

The Sunken Chapel

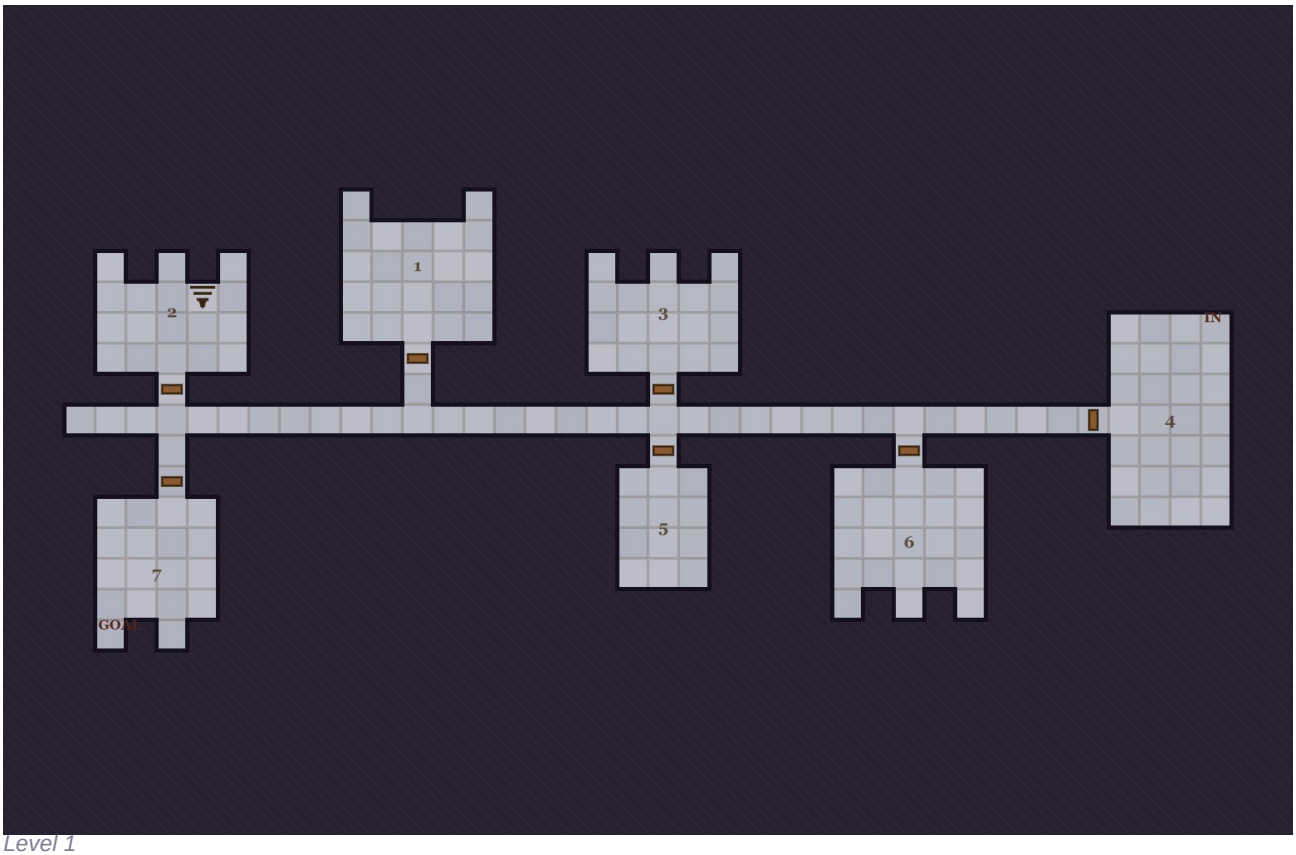
Location · blackwater · session-1 · dungeon

Kind: Tidal ruin; two-level crypt
Region: The Bell Coast

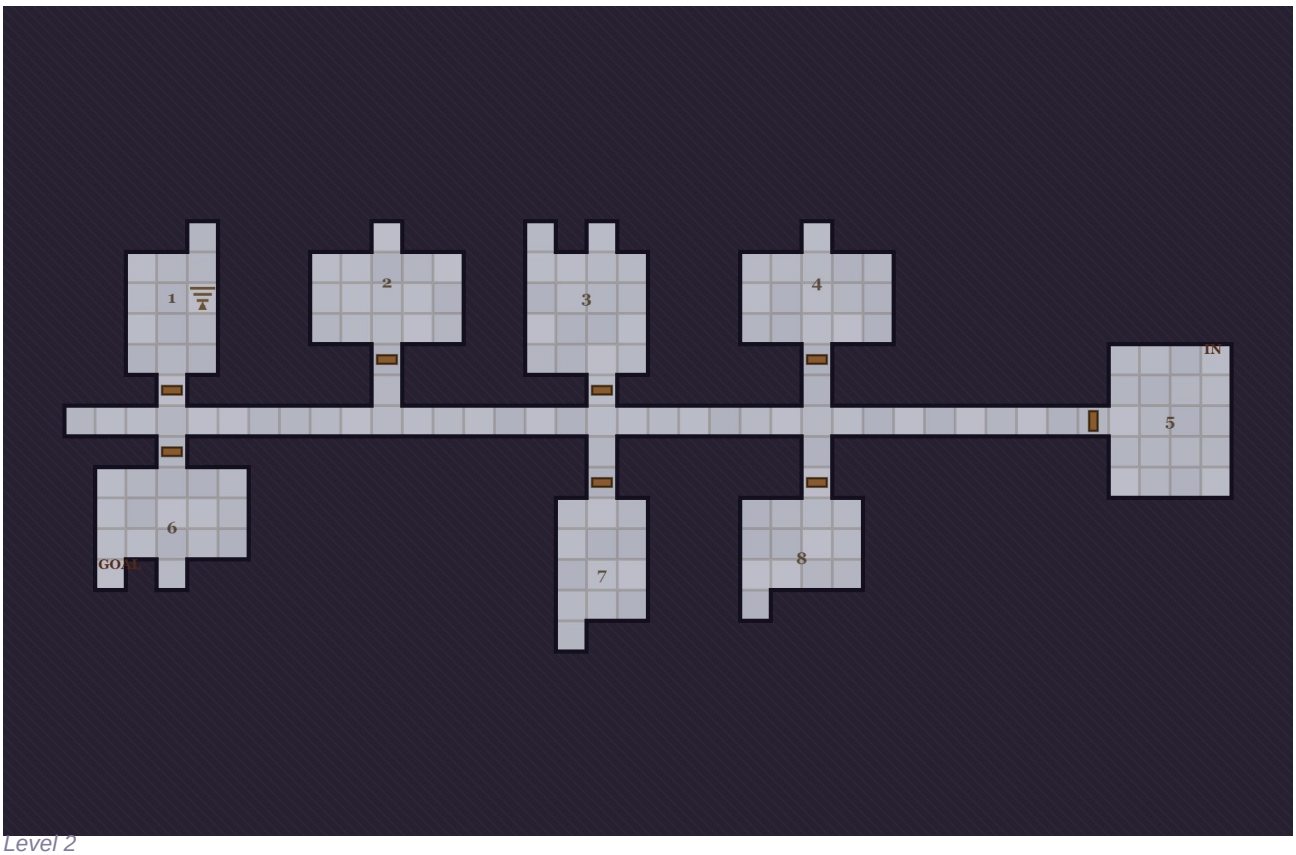
A ruined chapel on a tidal islet outside Blackwater. At low tide a causeway reaches the broken doors. The vault below still holds a bell dedicated to The Drowned Lantern.

What you see

Barnacled pews, green light under the altar, and wet footprints leading down dry stairs. A rope descends into a shaft where the bell should be.



Level 1



Level 2
Map of The Sunken Chapel (player version)

Factions

Tidemarket Guild

Faction · blackwater · guild

Leader: Mara Vell

The shipowners, fishmongers and porters who keep Blackwater fed. Their representative is Mara Vell. The Lantern Festival is their most profitable week.

Goals & methods

Keep trade moving, return the missing crew, and prevent panic. Pay discreet troubleshooters rather than call the militia.

Items

Saltglass Key

Item · blackwater · clue · session-1

A translucent green key, warm to the touch, with teeth shaped like waves. Salt water beads on it even when dry. Found in Nella Reed’s cargo.

Events

Lantern Festival
Event · Every year on 14 Lanternfall

On 14 Lanternfall, the people of Blackwater float lanterns for sailors who never returned. Brother Orin leads the blessing of The Drowned Lantern, while Mara Vell opens the market. The missing crew must be found before the bell rings at dusk.

Handouts

Mara’s Sealed Letter
Handout

Mara’s Sealed Letter

Mara Vell
Blackwater Harbor Office

12 Lanternfall, 112 AL

Tessa,

Seven days have vanished from the memories of the crew who came ashore this morning. Nella Reed is waiting by the east quay; she remembers a bell beneath the water, and nothing after it.

Find Brother Orin before the Lantern Festival. Ask him why the chapel bell is ringing when the tide has swallowed its tower. Take the Saltglass Key from my office, but keep it wrapped until you reach the causeway.

Bring our people home before the festival bell sounds at dusk. The harbor will stand behind you.

Keep this quiet,

Mara Vell

Saltglass Key — player card
Handout

A clue from Blackwater

Entrusted to Tessa by Mara Vell.

- Source: Saltglass Key

Gods

The Drowned Lantern
God · blackwater · religion

Domain: Lost sailors, memory, oaths
Symbol: A lantern beneath three waves

Worshippers: Fishers and lighthouse keepers

Patron of lost sailors and promises kept in darkness. Worshippers float lanterns on the harbor at the Lantern Festival. Brother Orin tends the last shrine in Blackwater.

Quests

The Bell Beneath the Bay

Quest · blackwater · session-1

Status: Open — investigate
Patron: Mara Vell
Stakes: The crew may lose their memories permanently
Next lead: Talk to Nella at the east docks

Mara Vell offers 50 gp to find the missing crew. Speak with Nella Reed at the docks and Brother Orin at the shrine. Follow the bell to The Sunken Chapel before the Lantern Festival.

- commissioned by: Mara Vell

Timeline

Current date: 12 Lanternfall 112 AL

Every year

Every year on 14 Lanternfall

Lantern Festival Event

On 14 Lanternfall, the people of Blackwater float lanterns for sailors who never returned. Brother Orin leads the blessing of The Drowned Lantern, while Mara Vell opens the market. The missing crew must be found before t

Tessa Brine

Dwarf · Fighter 2 · Soldier background · Neutral Good

STRENGTH	DEXTERITY	CONSTITUTION	INTELLIGENCE	WISDOM	CHARISMA
+3	+2	+2	+0	+1	-1
SCORE 17	SCORE 14	SCORE 14	SCORE 10	SCORE 12	SCORE 8

SAVING THROWS

●	Strength	+5
○	Dexterity	+2
●	Constitution	+4
○	Intelligence	+0
○	Wisdom	+1
○	Charisma	-1

SKILLS

○	Acrobatics	+2
○	Animal Handling	+1
○	Arcana	+0
●	Athletics	+5
○	Deception	-1
○	History	+0
●	Insight	+3
●	Intimidation	+1
○	Investigation	+0
○	Medicine	+1
○	Nature	+0
●	Perception	+3
○	Performance	-1
○	Persuasion	-1
○	Religion	+0
○	Sleight of Hand	+2
○	Stealth	+2
○	Survival	+1

PASSIVE PERCEPTION

13

ARMOR CLASS	INITIATIVE	SPEED
17	+2	30 ft.

HIT POINTS

Current 22 / Max 22
Temporary 0

HIT DICE & DEATH SAVES

2d10 · 0 spent

Successes ○ ○ ○

Failures ○ ○ ○

WEAPONS & ATTACKS

ATTACK	HIT	DAMAGE / TYPE
Greatsword	+5	2d6+3 slashing
Flail	+5	1d8+3 bludgeoning
Javelin	+5	1d6+3 piercing
Spear	+5	1d6+3 piercing
Shortbow	+4	1d6+2 piercing

FEATURES & TRAITS · DESCRIPTIONS FOLLOW

Darkvision
Dwarven Resilience
Dwarven Toughness
Stonecunning
Fighting Style
Second Wind
Weapon Mastery
Savage Attacker
Defense
Weapon Mastery
Action Surge
Tactical Mind

PROFICIENCIES & LANGUAGES

Proficiency bonus +2 · Common, Dwarvish, Elvish
light, medium, heavy, shield, simple, martial, Gaming set of your choice

Tessa Brine

Equipment, personality & features

Identity

Dwarf · Fighter 2 · Soldier background · Neutral Good

Equipment & treasure

1 × Chain Mail
1 × Greatsword
1 × Flail
8 × Javelin
1 × Dungeoneer's Pack
1 × Spear
1 × Shortbow
20 × Arrow
1 × Dragonchess Set
1 × Healer's Kit
1 × Quiver
1 × Traveler's Clothes

Coins: 18 gp · 0 sp · 0 cp

Weapons & attack notes

Greatsword: +5 to hit; 2d6+3 slashing
H, 2H · Graze

Flail: +5 to hit; 1d8+3 bludgeoning
Sap

Javelin: +5 to hit; 1d6+3 piercing
T · Slow

Spear: +5 to hit; 1d6+3 piercing
T, V · Sap

Shortbow: +4 to hit; 1d6+2 piercing
A, 2H · Vex

Traits

Counts exits before sitting down; always carries spare rope.

Ideals

No crew member gets left behind.

Bonds

Mara Vell once saved her from a shipwreck.

Flaws

Distrusts anyone who keeps their hands hidden.

Darkvision · Dwarf

You have Darkvision with a range of 120 feet.

Tessa Brine

Equipment, personality & features · continued

Dwarven Resilience · Dwarf

You have Resistance to Poison damage. You also have Advantage on saving throws you make to avoid or end the Poisoned condition.

Dwarven Toughness · Dwarf

Your Hit Point maximum increases by 1, and it increases by 1 again whenever you gain a level.

Stonecunning · Dwarf

As a Bonus Action, you gain Tremorsense with a range of 60 feet for 10 minutes. You must be on a stone surface or touching a stone surface to use this Tremorsense. The stone can be natural or worked.

You can use this Bonus Action a number of times equal to your Proficiency Bonus, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Long Rest.

Fighting Style · Fighter 1

You have honed your martial prowess and gain a Fighting Style feat of your choice. Defense is recommended.

Whenever you gain a Fighter level, you can replace the feat you chose with a different Fighting Style feat.

Second Wind · Fighter 1

You have a limited well of physical and mental stamina that you can draw on. As a Bonus Action, you can use it to regain Hit Points equal to 1d10 plus your Fighter level.

You can use this feature twice. You regain one expended use when you finish a Short Rest, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Long Rest.

When you reach certain Fighter levels, you gain more uses of this feature, as shown in the Second Wind column of the Fighter Features table.

Weapon Mastery · Fighter 1

Your training with weapons allows you to use the mastery properties of three kinds of Simple or Martial weapons of your choice. Whenever you finish a Long Rest, you can practice weapon drills and change one of those weapon choices.

When you reach certain Fighter levels, you gain the ability to use the mastery properties of more kinds of weapons, as shown in the Weapon Mastery column of the Fighter Features table.

Savage Attacker · Origin feat

You've trained to deal particularly damaging strikes. Once per turn when you hit a target with a weapon, you can roll the weapon's damage dice twice and use either roll against the target.

Defense · Fighting Style

While you're wearing Light, Medium, or Heavy armor, you gain a +1 bonus to Armor Class.

Weapon Mastery · Character choice

Greatsword, flail and spear. Former harbor watch; trained to fight on narrow quays.

Action Surge · Fighter 2

You can push yourself beyond your normal limits for a moment. On your turn, you can take one additional action, except the Magic action.

Tessa Brine

Equipment, personality & features · continued

Action Surge · Fighter 2 · continued

Once you use this feature, you can't do so again until you finish a Short or Long Rest. Starting at level 17, you can use it twice before a rest but only once on a turn.

Tactical Mind · Fighter 2

You have a mind for tactics on and off the battlefield. When you fail an ability check, you can expend a use of your Second Wind to push yourself toward success. Rather than regaining Hit Points, you roll 1d10 and add the number rolled to the ability check, potentially turning it into a success. If the check still fails, this use of Second Wind isn't expended.

Notes & backstory

A former harbor watch soldier from Blackwater, looking for Nella Reed’s missing crew. Proficient with a dragonchess set.

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